



MENTAL STRENGTH

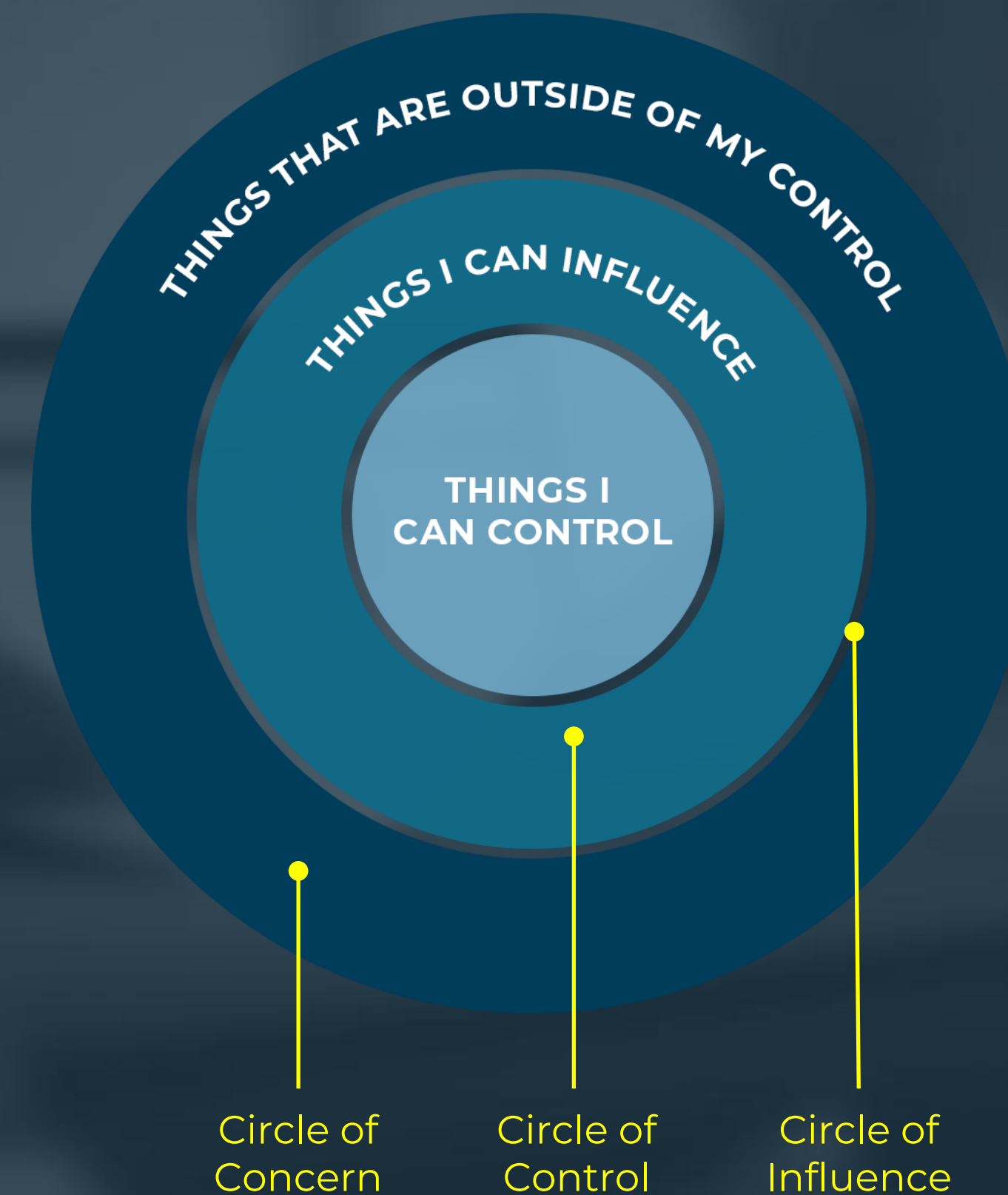
Focus on What You Can Control

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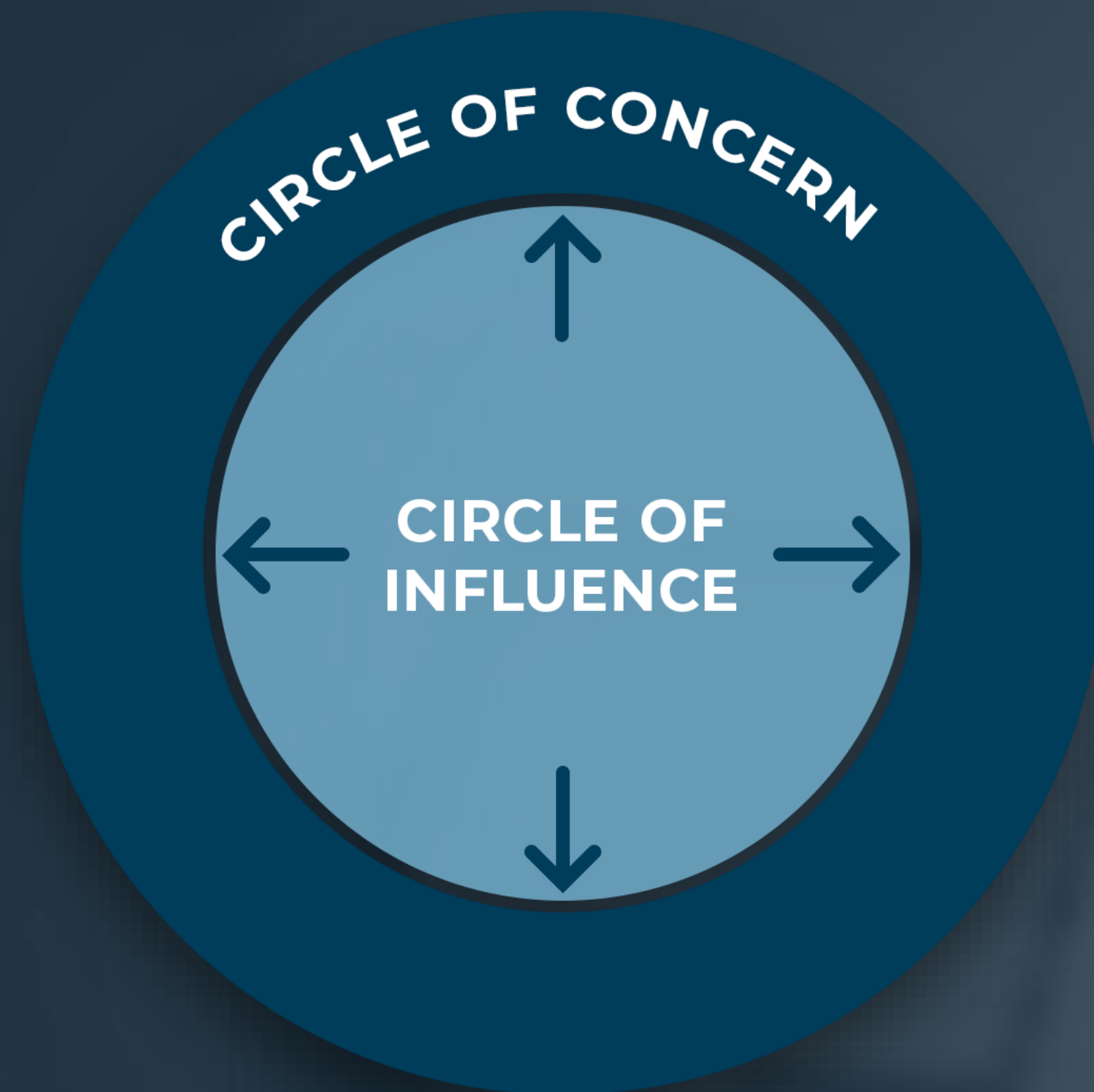
WE SHOULD FOCUS ON AND WORK TO IMPROVE:

- 1 The 'Circle of Control' - issues involving our own behaviour, our thoughts, emotions, interpretations, reactions, and actions - we have Direct Control.
 - 2 The 'Circle of Influence' - problems involving other people's behaviour, their actions, and perceptions - we have Indirect Control.
-  We should ignore problems/issues over which we have No Control; the Circle of Concern.

3 CATEGORIES OF CONCERN

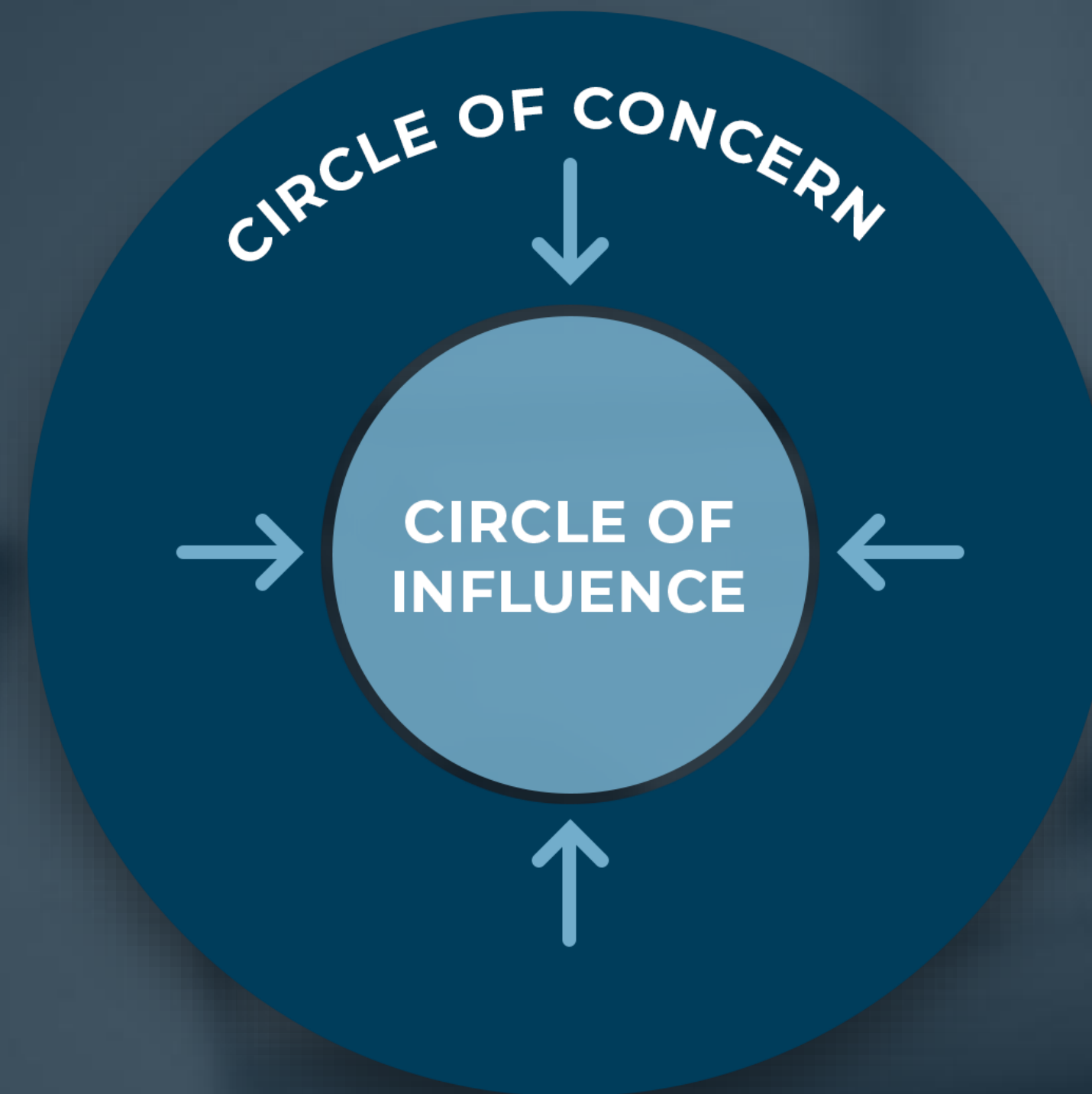


Focus on What You Can Control



PROACTIVE FOCUS

Positive energy enlarges
Circle of Influence



REACTIVE FOCUS

Negative energy reduces
Circle of Influence

COVEY'S CIRCLE OF INFLUENCE

Circle of Concern – everything that concerns us – such as health, children, problems at work, other people's attitudes and behaviours, external events.

Circle of Influence / Control - things of Concern that we can Control (our behaviours) or Influence (other people's behaviours).

Focus on What You Can Control

Best Practice

**WE SHOULD FOCUS ON
AND WORK TO IMPROVE:**

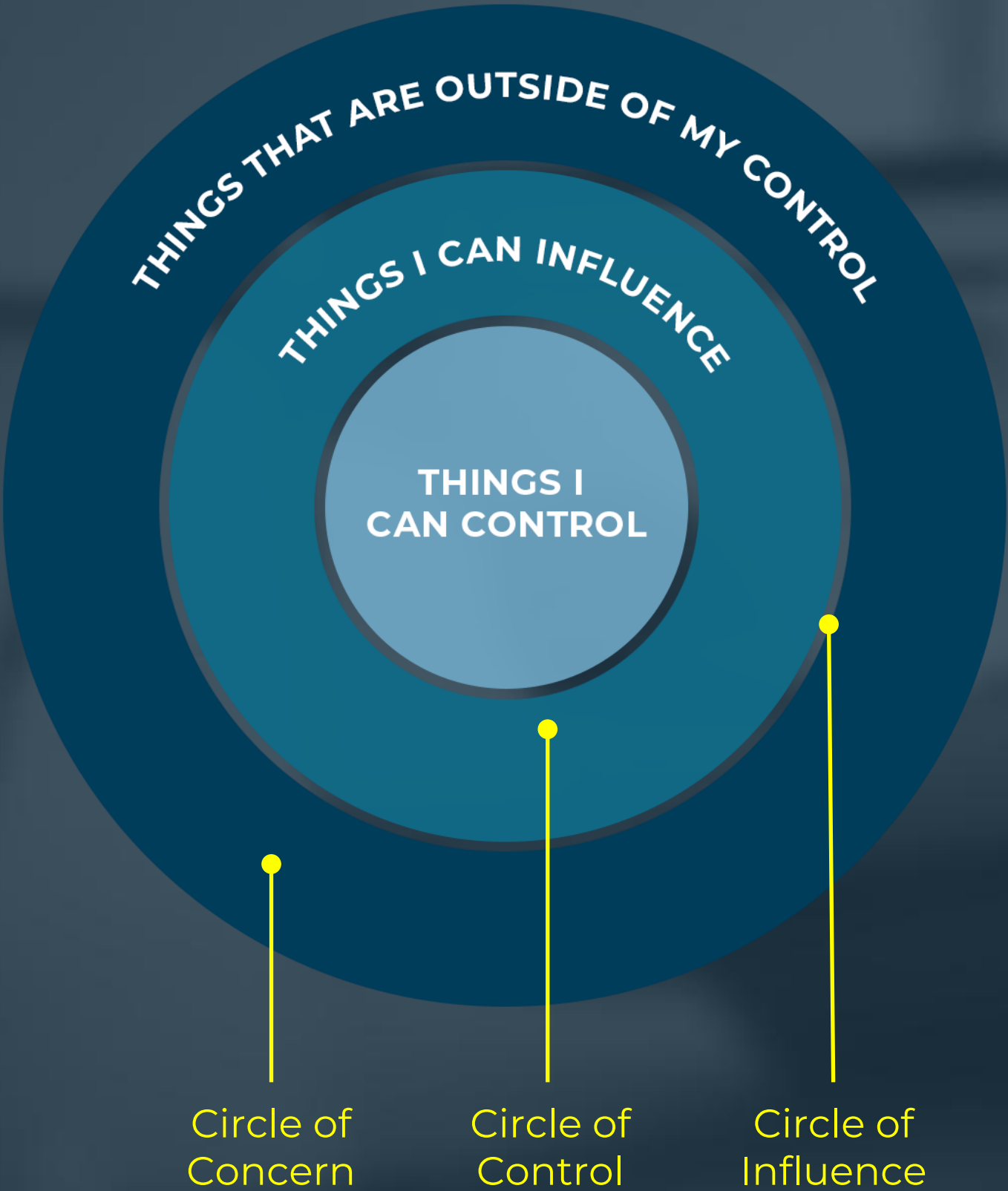
- 1

The Circle of Control’ - issues involving our own behaviour, our thoughts, emotions, interpretations, reactions, and actions - we have Direct Control.
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- 

We should ignore problems/issues over which we have No Control; the Circle of Concern.

3 CATEGORIES OF CONCERN



**EXAMPLES OF ITEMS
WITHIN THE 3 CATEGORIES**

Circle of Control <i>Direct control</i>	Circle of Influence <i>Indirect Control</i>	Circle of Concern <i>No Control</i>
Unhealthy eating, lack of exercise	Working with a difficult team dynamic	Pandemic Restrictions
Not enough time dedicated to planning	Meeting deadlines on projects involving others	Re-organisation
Work ethic	Personal reputation	Past events
Unclear purpose or personal goals	Unclear work priorities	Other people’s personality

Focus on What You Can Control



Within our control are our thoughts, emotions, and interpretations, as well as our reactions and actions.



These are the things that we should focus on and work to improve.



Use the following Exercise to categorise your concerns and begin focusing on what you can control.

EXERCISE

CATEGORISE YOUR CONCERNS

1

Using template 1, write down all your current concerns within the circle.

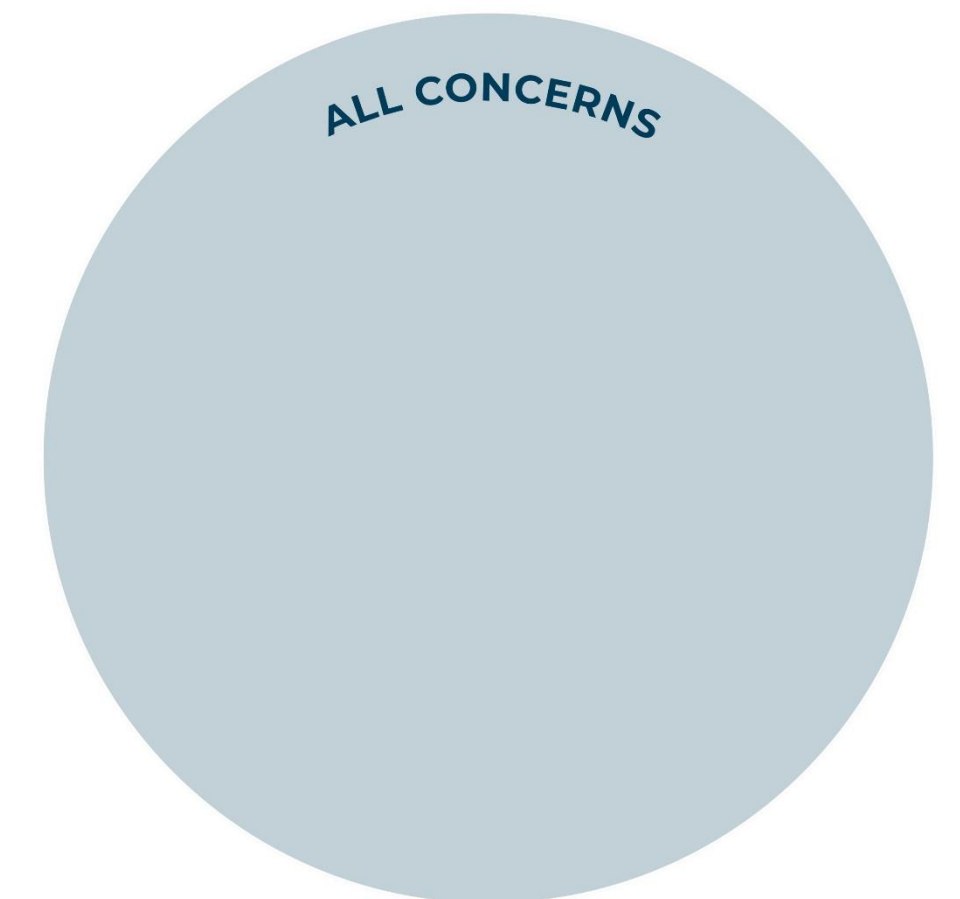
2

Using template 2, move the concerns into the 2 new circles as follows:

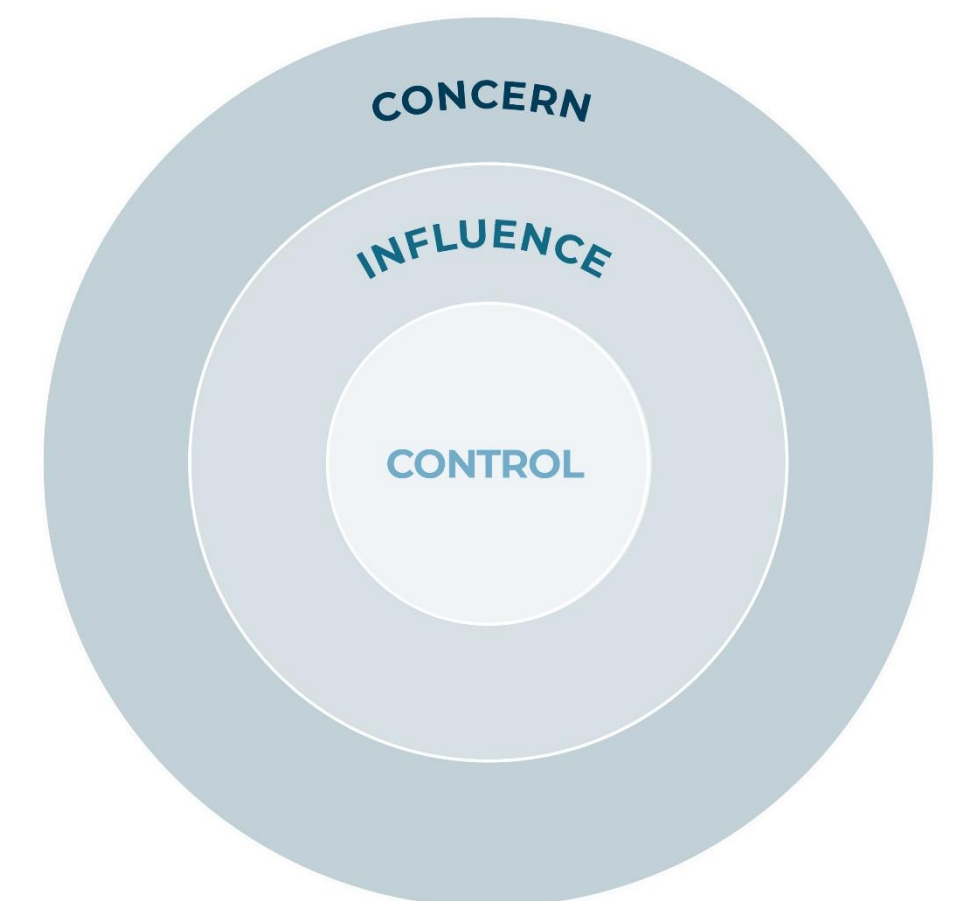
- **Your Circle of Influence** - items you can influence / have partial control over the outcome of this through your own actions or behaviour
- **Your Circle of Control** - items over which you have complete control that you can resolve on your own without needing anyone's help or input.

3

What remains in your original Circle of Concern are the items completely outside your control or influence



Template 1



Template 2

Focus on What You Can Control

Key Strategies for focusing on what you can control - Circle of Control

How to influence and expand your Circle of Control ('Direct Control')



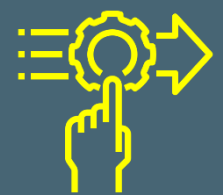
Identify what you can control

- by assessing your current concerns, separating them into those in your Circle of Concern, Influence and Control.



Focus your energy and attention

- on the latter, concentrating on actions you can take to improve your situation.



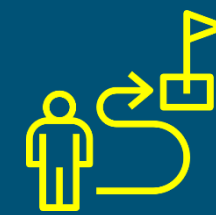
Be proactive not reactive

Influence your circumstances by working on the things you can do something about.



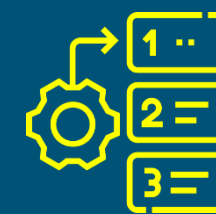
Find your purpose

- the driving force that provides motivation and fulfilment.



Begin with the end in mind

Visualise your goals and desired outcome before embarking on a project, career, or life journey.



Put first things first

Prioritise your work and focus on what is most important even if it's difficult.



Constantly challenge your perceptions

- and self-limiting beliefs to check if there is any room to expand the sphere of control.



Have a growth mindset

Continuously expand your knowledge and skills enabling you to tackle a wider range of challenges.



Seek support and guidance

- from mentors, friends, and professionals to help you make more informed decisions.

Focus on What You Can Control

How to influence and expand your Circle of Influence



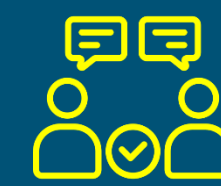
Now focus your energy and attention

- on things in your Circle of Influence, concentrating on actions you can take to improve your situation.



Adopt a 'Win/Win' attitude

- that seeks mutually beneficial outcomes in all interactions, rather than there being a winner and loser.



Show empathy

- for other people's point of view, then seek to have your point of view understood from this frame of reference.



Embrace synergy

The combined power of people working together is greater than the total power achieved by each working separately, and value differences between people.

Dealing with your Circle of Concern ('No Control') problems



Accept

- that you cannot control the items in your Circle of Concern.



Focus on your responses

- to these uncontrollable factors, to let go of unnecessary stress and worry and increase your Circle of Influence.

CONCLUSION

Focusing our efforts and time on Concerns within our Circle of Influence/Control, and also changing how we respond to factors beyond our control, will influence outcomes, expand our Circle of Influence, and make us more effective, productive and more resilient.